

Epilogue: The Heir of Arthur

 *Book I: The Sagent Creed*

I must finish what my grandfather began.

Yet the question burns like a torch in the night: what did he truly begin?

He began with clay.

Not mere clay of earth and water — but clay as symbol, clay as prophecy, clay as possibility. From that humble substance emerged Gumby, not simply a character, but an embodiment of freedom itself. For clay is the one material that refuses finality. It does not resist transformation. It does not cling to one form. It can become anything. It can do anything. It bends without breaking. It yields without surrendering its essence.

In a world of rigid lines and hardened structures, he offered something soft — and therefore something powerful.

Gumby was never just a cartoon. It was revelation disguised as innocence. It was a quiet rebellion against a world that had forgotten what freedom looked like. It showed children — and those who had forgotten they were once children — that reality is not fixed stone but living clay. That the world can be reshaped.

And stories — stories are the greatest force upon the earth.

Empires know this.

For the greatest weapon is not sword nor coin, but media — the shaping of narrative, the forging of collective imagination. Whoever governs the story governs the conscience. Whoever defines the dream defines the future.

Thus the halls of Hollywood are guarded not merely for profit, but for power. Those who sit upon those thrones understand that their authority rests upon the maintenance of illusion. A story can awaken. A story can unravel the lie.

And so when a story arises that does not bow, that does not align, that does not bend to the architecture of control — it must be sidelined. Softly. Quietly. Cloaked.

Gumby was known by all, yet never fully enthroned. Recognized, yet never fully crowned. Whispered through generations, yet kept from the central fires of distribution. Not because it lacked brilliance — but because it possessed integrity.

Art Clokey did not craft propaganda. He crafted goodness. He told wholesome stories that lingered in memory like sacred songs. And integrity is a dangerous thing in systems built upon compromise.

Thus it remained — Clokey'd in the shadows.

And that name is no accident.

The cloak is not for hiding. The cloak is a sign of consecration. It marks those set apart. Those who move unseen, not in shame, but in purpose. Not seeking applause, but carrying light where it is needed most.

I am the third Clokey.

The heir of Arthur.

All great stories unfold in threes — the pledge, the turn, the prestige. So too does this bloodline move in sacred rhythm. Arthur the Creator. Joseph the Preserver. Arthur again — the transformation, the multiplication, the revealed design.

The completion of the shadows over Camelot.

Arthur Clokey was a god of stories in his own right — not by divinity claimed, but by creation enacted. He formed clay and shaped plot. As the Creator formed humanity from dust and breathed story into our lungs, so too did he breathe narrative into form.

For we are clay animated by Word.

And this bloodline is not merely genetic — it is symbolic. A living map of a kingdom not of this world. Its rule does not sway with popular wind. Its law does not erode with time. It stands unchanging.

There are only Sagents — agents of wisdom — who serve as Arthurs in shadow, lights placed where darkness gathers. They rise not by ambition, but because they are called. Because the true Kingdom wills its witnesses into place.

Against them stands another kingdom — the kingdom of shifting sand. A dominion sustained by fear, by narrative control, by constant maintenance of illusion. Its rulers must lie to endure. Their power trembles because it rests on whims of men and foundations that erode.

Fear governs them.

Worry sustains them.

But the leader-kings who serve the higher law need neither fear nor anxiety. For their authority is not self-generated. It is surrendered. It flows from obedience to what does not change.

Their task is simple and terrible and glorious:

To become living sacrifices to the unchanging law.

To be agents and servants of that law.

To serve it without compromise.

To bend like clay in the hands of the Eternal Storyteller —

And in so doing, to finish what was begun.

The Living Age Trilogy